



YouTube Shorts finally out of beta

TikTok rival YouTube Shorts is finally out of beta and is rolling out to all US users.
<http://dgit.in/jun21-23>



Google releases Android 12 beta

Android 12 beta is now available for Pixel smartphones and other supported phones.
<http://dgit.in/jun21-24>

Gaining coins and dropping warranties

The latest crypto currency isn't targeting your GPUs

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ost SSDs usually come with five year warranties and the more durable and premium SSDs

families sport up to ten year warranties. That's all set to change with the advent of Chia coin mining. What separates Chia coin from other cryptocurrencies is that you need to use storage media to mine it. This is because it doesn't use Proof of Work or Proof of Stake for its Blockchain algorithm. Instead it implements Proof of Space ... well you could call it Proof of Time and Space.

Proof of Space works by storing a collection of cryptographics numbers on a storage medium as "plots". Users who wish to mine Chia coins will have to dedicate a portion of their storage for storing these plots. Chia calls these users "farmers" and when the blockchain broadcasts a challenge for the upcoming block, these farmers can scan the plots on their storage drives to see if they have the hash that is closest to the newly broadcasted challenge. Then comes the Proof of Time concept which is implemented by a Verifiable Delay Function (VDF). This takes a certain amount of time to compute, though not much. VDF is sequential and not parallel, so using a GPGPU accelerator such as a graphics card cannot speed up this process. Once the computation

is verified, the block is awarded and you get your share of however many Chia coins a block contains, at that point in time. This makes it much more energy efficient than Proof of Work cryptocurrencies.

Chia coin farming requires storage media that sport fast transfer speeds and also have high capacities. So while it can run on hard drives, SSDs would perform better. Moreover,

storage requirement. So K=33 takes 208.8 GB and K=34 needs 429.8 GB. There are certain inefficiencies with plotting higher sizes, so most miners prefer to plot K=32.

What does this mean for you? Every SSD, from the smallest 120 GB capacity to the largest 4 TB capacity can be used for farming Chia coins. And because a massive amount of storage space is used up for saving



there is a certain minimum storage required for each plot. This is indicated by the 'K' number and K=32 is the minimum plot size that is eligible to get onto the network. And a K=32 plot size takes up 101.4 GB with each additional K-number doubling the

the plot sizes, as well as for scanning, there is a constant need for reading and writing across the entire storage medium. SSDs have limited read-write cycles so running a Chia plotting software will eat up your SSD's endurance. And if we remember the fact